

pletely into Adobe's cloud ecosystem? Only time will tell.

Samsung

The South Korean company has really leveraged the smartphone, tablet boom to cement its position as one of the world's leading OEMs and make Samsung a household name – in fact its Galaxy brand of devices is stronger than Android, the OS it's based on. 4K TVs are coming, and so is a high-end Tizen smartphone (would you believe it?!), as Samsung slowly tries to de-emphasize Android and Windows Phone, according to Lee Young Hee, executive vice president of Samsung's mobile division. And it's also working on a mind-controlled tablet, where a user can launch apps by just thinking about them, according to the MIT Technology Review, although there's no launch date on the horizon yet.

It's all about wearable tech in the near future, apart from consolidating its share in the tablets, smartphones and HDTV markets. Flexible screens, smart watches, and more recently the company's focusing its efforts in driving innovation in the health sector. At a recent conference in San Francisco, Young Sohn, Strategy chief at Samsung said, "We think the health area is a really key area of innovation."

Apple

The Cupertino giant is not just a technology bigwig but one of the top companies in the world. But ever since Steve Jobs demise the company's aura of invincibility has taken a huge beating and its growth is slowing down. The world is waiting on Apple to cause a tectonic shift in a whole new market and thereby revives its sagging fortunes. Rumour mills are abuzz with analysts' predicting the next big Apple product. Hint: it's not an iPhone.

For over a year now, Apple has been rumoured of working on a smartwatch – an iWatch, if you will – and these reports have amplified in intensity in the last few months with leaked dossiers, personnel appointments, and anonymous sources cranking up the media hype machine. All signs of an impending launch in the coming months. How will an Apple smartwatch change the world? We are as clueless as anyone else. The company's also allegedly working on an HDTV, which is slated for launch later this year or early next year.

iPads and iPhones will keep churning out, but could Apple be working on a budget, stripped down version of the iPhone? No matter how hard anyone tries to dismiss these reports, the rumours surrounding this project just refuse to go away.

Google

It's hard to separate the Web from Google and vice-versa. The search giant's one of the biggest enablers of the readable, accessible Web, and it has built a virtual hegemony around it, an unrivalled empire. Everything that Google does – whether its Android or Chrome OS – it funnels back to feed and drive its search, ad, and online app store businesses. But Google is so enormously huge with its fingers dipped in such diverse business units that it's difficult to predict where its future lies. Self-driving cars, anyone?

That's where the company's CEO, Larry Page's words help you grasp the company's current mood and future outlook. Page is a



huge fan of Google Glass, the voice-controlled HMD that lets you interact with surroundings and technology in a whole new way, and strongly believes it's the future. ZDNet quoted Page as saying, "We're obviously excited about Google Glass. With any technological change you probably overestimate the short-term and underestimate the long-term. So I think our – we're really excited about making those investments and making sure we're positioned to the future. That's why I love using Glass because I feel like every time I'm using Glass I'm living that future, that's really, really exciting to me."

ARM

The company that enabled the smartphone and tablet revolution, popularizing the RISC-based architecture in a number of "smart" embedded and mobile devices

around us. However, smartphones and tablets have arrived and are here to stay. But with Intel finally ramping up its mobile chip offering and hoping to make a significant dent in the market, what will drive ARM's growth in the future?

According to a report, ARM's future lies in datacenters and the Internet of Things (through sensors). According to its Executive Vice President of Strategy, Tom Lantzsch, sensors leveraging RF technology (and powered by ARM chips) are going to get smaller and smaller and be "put into paint or in concrete." It's also working with GE on making self-monitoring street lights. Materials semiconductor tech is a huge focus area for ARM.

At another extreme, ARM's poised to make significant inroads in Intel's mainstay – the server market. It doesn't make sense, right? How can servers based on x86-x64 architecture be replaced by ARM's RISC platform? However, as more and more smartphones and tablets tap into the Internet, ARM-based servers and datacenters can reduce power consumption and simplify solutions in the long term, compared to Intel's racks. What's more, there's heavy speculation that AMD will soon join forces with ARM and give the company leverage as it enters untested waters.

Sony

The Japanese multinational is no longer the force it was, but it remains a big player in areas of gaming and entertainment, and tries hard to take a sizable chunk of the smartphone-tablet pie. But this year, it's all about the PlayStation 4, and the future of gaming and online entertainment.

Sony PS4's killer features consist of a never-before-seen-or-heard cloud gaming service that will let you download and watch a friend's gameplay in real-time, join him if you feel like, and do other cool game-related things through the future of PSN. Sony's also keeping the PS Vita and other tablets and smartphones relevant to the PS4 experience by allowing you to take your game experience away from the console and your large-screen TV. It aims to make the PS4 the centerpiece of your gaming and connected entertainment experience, by syncing with BRAVIA TVs, Blu-ray players, Xperia smartphones and tablets. All indications are that Sony has the infrastructure in place to kickstart its vision of seamless, interconnected entertainment. 